

▲ GLAIVE

Date c.1250–1500

Origin Scotland

Weight 2.7kg (6lb)

Length (Head) 79cm (31in)

The glaive had a blade that resembled a modern kitchen knife, with a sharp point at the end, as well as a wider, curved cutting edge.

▲ LOCHABER AXE

Date 1400

Origin Scotland

Weight 2.3kg (5lb)

Length (Head) 45cm (17¾in)

A variant of the halberd, the Lochaber axe had a sharp hook on the back that could be used in close combat or to pull cavalry off their horses.

Sharp hook

Long scythe-like blade

Straight quillon

Long grip

▲ TWO-HANDED SWORD

Date c.1500

Origin Germany

Weight 2.7kg (6lb)

Length 1.35m (4½ft)

Too heavy to use in open combat, two-handed swords were generally reserved for single combat or to defend town walls. They had grips that were long in proportion to the blade, and sharply tapering points.

Tapering double-edged blade

Long wooden shaft was gripped in both hands

Spearhead

▲ PIKE

Date c.1500

Origin Germany

Weight (Head) 57g (2oz)

Length 4–5m (13–16½ft)

Evolving from a long infantryman's spear, the pike kept getting longer until the 15th century, when the Swiss began using them in formations. As with the hoplite phalanxes of Ancient Greece (see pp.24–25), these units were almost impenetrable to cavalry.

Long curved blade

Small spike

Lower part of blade attaches to shaft

▲ BARDICHE

Date c.1580

Origin Russia

Weight 2.5kg (5½lb)

Length (Head) 77cm (30¼in)

The bardiche was popular in Scandinavia, Eastern Europe, and Russia. It had a long narrow blade with no lugs or hooks (unlike halberds). The lower end of the axehead was attached to the wooden shaft.

Rondel to protect hands

Langet steel strip to protect shaft from other edged weapons

Long thin spike

Hammer head